

Question:

What is aschizo-affectivedisorder ?

Answer Choices:

- A. A schizo-affective disorder is a term used to describe a personality disorder with features similar to both schizophrenia and affective disorders.
- B. A schizo-affective disorder exclusively involves psychotic symptoms without any mood disturbances.
- C. A schizo-affective disorder is a psychological condition where mood disorders occur as a reaction to schizophrenia treatment.
- D. A schizo-affective disorder is characterized by periods of well-being between episodes of schizophrenia and mood disorders.
- E. A schizo-affective disorder is a combination of schizophrenic and affective disorders, where the affective symptoms must develop before or simultaneously with the psychotic symptoms.
- F. A schizo-affective disorder is a subtype of affective disorders.
- G. A schizo-affective disorder is a subtype of schizophrenia.
- H. A schizo-affective disorder develops after the onset of psychosis.
- I. A schizo-affective disorder is a chronic condition with only affective or mood-related symptoms.
- J. A schizo-affective disorder is a mild form of schizophrenia that does not include affective symptoms.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>  
Schizo-affective disorder, as defined in DSM-5, is not a hybrid personality or overlap between schizophrenia and affective disorders (options A, F, G). It is characterized by persistent delusions, hallucinations, or disorganized speech and behavior—criteria for schizophrenia—that are present during a majority of the total duration of either the active or residual phase. In addition, it meets the diagnostic criteria for a mood episode (depressive, bipolar, or mixed). Therefore, it is a formally recognized nosologic category within schizophrenia and must include psychotic symptoms alongside mood disturbances; it cannot exist without psychosis (ruling out option B). It is distinct from the affective subtype of schizophrenia, which emphasizes mood features but not schizophrenia symptoms (ruled out by treating it as schizophrenia; options C, H). By contrast, the description of affective symptoms arising after the onset of psychosis (option I) describes reactive mood disorder superimposed on psychosis, not schizo-affective disorder.

Correct answer: E. A schizo-affective disorder is a combination of schizophrenic and affective disorders, where the affective symptoms must develop before or simultaneously with the psychotic symptoms.

</think>  
<answer>  
E. A schizo-affective disorder is a combination of schizophrenic and affective disorders, where the affective symptoms must develop before or simultaneously with the psychotic symptoms.  
</answer>